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Too many chickens coming home to roost

Peabody farm owner pleads for end to ‘rooster-dumping’

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Sure, roosters don’t lay eggs and are known to make a racket, so most amateur chick hatching don’t have any use for them. But, the Wood Family Farm would like you to know it already has plenty, thanks all the same.

Madison Wood, caretaker of the Peabody farm, is pleading with people to stop leaving unwanted roosters on her property after 10 have been unceremoniously thrown over her fence in the past six months.

“Rooster dumping” has been a problem since her family began tending the roughly one-and-a-

half acres of farmland two decades ago.

But it’s getting much worse, and with the recent surge of discarded roosters, she now has 15 on her hands.

“I am just a 25-year-old girl taking care of her family’s farm, and it keeps falling on me to take these roosters in when they’re dumped,” Wood said.

While roosters have short lifespans that have reduced their numbers over the years, Wood has taken care of every single bird left on the property so far, providing them with feed and a place in her paddock alongside her ducks and cows.

ROOSTERS, Page A10



MADISON WOOD

Madison Wood said 10 roosters have been left at her family’s farm in six months.

Big switch to housing divides Waltham

Council moves to override mayor’s ‘no’ on proposal to convert large office sites

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

In the sprawling reaches of the commercial office corridor arrayed along Route 128 in Waltham, a slumping market has forced local officials to confront a thorny new feature of the suburban fabric: empty buildings, one seemingly after another.

Two of the city’s biggest owners of those buildings, as well as members of the Waltham City Council, believe they have a solution: turn three of the downtrodden commercial districts into more than 2,000 new units of housing. They would be the biggest residential development projects in recent memory in this city of 65,000, bringing a neighborhood feel to what is largely a forlorn stretch of business.

But earlier in July, Waltham Mayor Jeannette McCarthy vetoed a measure that would clear the way to redevelop the largest of the three office parks, citing concerns about density, and observed the fact that the project would be “conveniently placed next to a residential neighborhood.”

“Why, with all the land that is available on the site, was it placed so close to the existing neighborhood?” she wrote in a letter to the City Council.

And she worried big developments would only

WALTHAM, Page A6



PHOTOS BY JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Alison Malkin, a licensed independent clinical social worker, maintains licenses in five states, including Massachusetts.

Mass. limits out-of-state therapists

Nationwide compacts allow for treatment, but here, other rules apply

By Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Tisha Bailey moved to Massachusetts from Maine in January, she’d hoped her therapist of a year and a half would be able to continue seeing her through telehealth.

But Massachusetts law bars residents from making virtual appointments with out-of-state therapists unless the therapist has a license to practice in Massachusetts. So, Bailey spent six months trying to find a new provider, encountering long wait lists, compatibility issues, and the challenge of recounting traumatic memories to someone new.

Had Bailey, a 23-year-old who now lives in Woburn, moved to any other New England state, reconnecting with her therapist in Maine would have been possible.

Massachusetts is the only state in the region — and one of just six states in the nation — that has not passed legislation to join any of the three nationwide legal agreements allowing licensed mental health professionals

MENTAL HEALTH, Page A7



Tisha Bailey, had to switch therapists when she moved to Massachusetts from Maine, because her previous provider didn’t have a license here. She spent months trying to find care.

Trade unions see bonanza in data centers

Long-term, well-paying work outweighs concerns

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

For many residents of Western Massachusetts, the proposal to build a massive data center complex in Westfield seems like a nightmare.

For Jeremy Dunn, it sounds like a dream come true.

“It means an absolute astounding number of jobs,” said Dunn, business manager at Local 7 of the International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers, the union local serving Westfield.

Michael Langone, business manager of Plumbers and Pipefitters Local 104 in Holyoke, is just as effusive. “It would be an absolute game-changer,” said Langone. “This goes above and beyond any construction project we’ve ever seen in Western Massachusetts. This would be hundreds and hundreds, thousands of construction jobs.”

Where data center critics fear that the huge facilities will drain local water supplies and cause surging electric bills, construction union leaders see a bonanza of high-paying jobs and a major opportunity to train the next generation of skilled

DATA CENTERS, Page A6



Bloom burg

Saturday: Humid, cloudy. High: 78-83. Low: 67-72.

Sunday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 80-85. Low: 69-74.

Sunrise: 5:37 Sunset: 8:04

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Communities and farms across Arizona, Nevada, and California face potentially drastic cuts in the water they can use from the Colorado River over the next decade under a Trump administration plan. **A2.**

Hamas said that it will begin disarming as part of a deal announced by President Trump that also requires Israel to end its strikes and withdraw from Gaza. **A3.**

Jurors in the murder trial of Lindsay Clancy viewed the Duxbury home where her three young children were strangled in the basement. **B1.**

A federal appellate panel upheld a lower court ruling tossing out a lawsuit by Ralph de la Torre, the former CEO of Steward Health Care, against US senators who held him in contempt for failing to comply with a subpoena. **D1.**

Influencers’ Nantucket view is too small

When all you see of the island is a social media post, you miss the point

By Katie McNerney
GLOBE STAFF

If you missed the latest internet dustup, you’re better for it. For those who need a catch-up: A Nantucket business owner hung a quarterboard in his antique and crafts shop that read “No Influencers.” An influencer who recently opened a storefront down the street had a problem with that.

The debate isn’t about the idea of influencer as a worthy profession, although that is what struck a nerve for Paige Paul (formerly Paige Lorenze), who has more than 2 million social media followers.

The issue is that influencers boil down the Nantucket experience to something that fits neatly in an Instagram post. And if you do that, you miss what makes Nantucket magical.

Paul may not have that same perspective. She grew up summering on island, privileged enough to have grandparents with a home

NANTUCKET, Page A10



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2024

Anyone can travel to Nantucket vicariously through their phone, but a sunset over Nantucket Sound is more than a pretty picture.